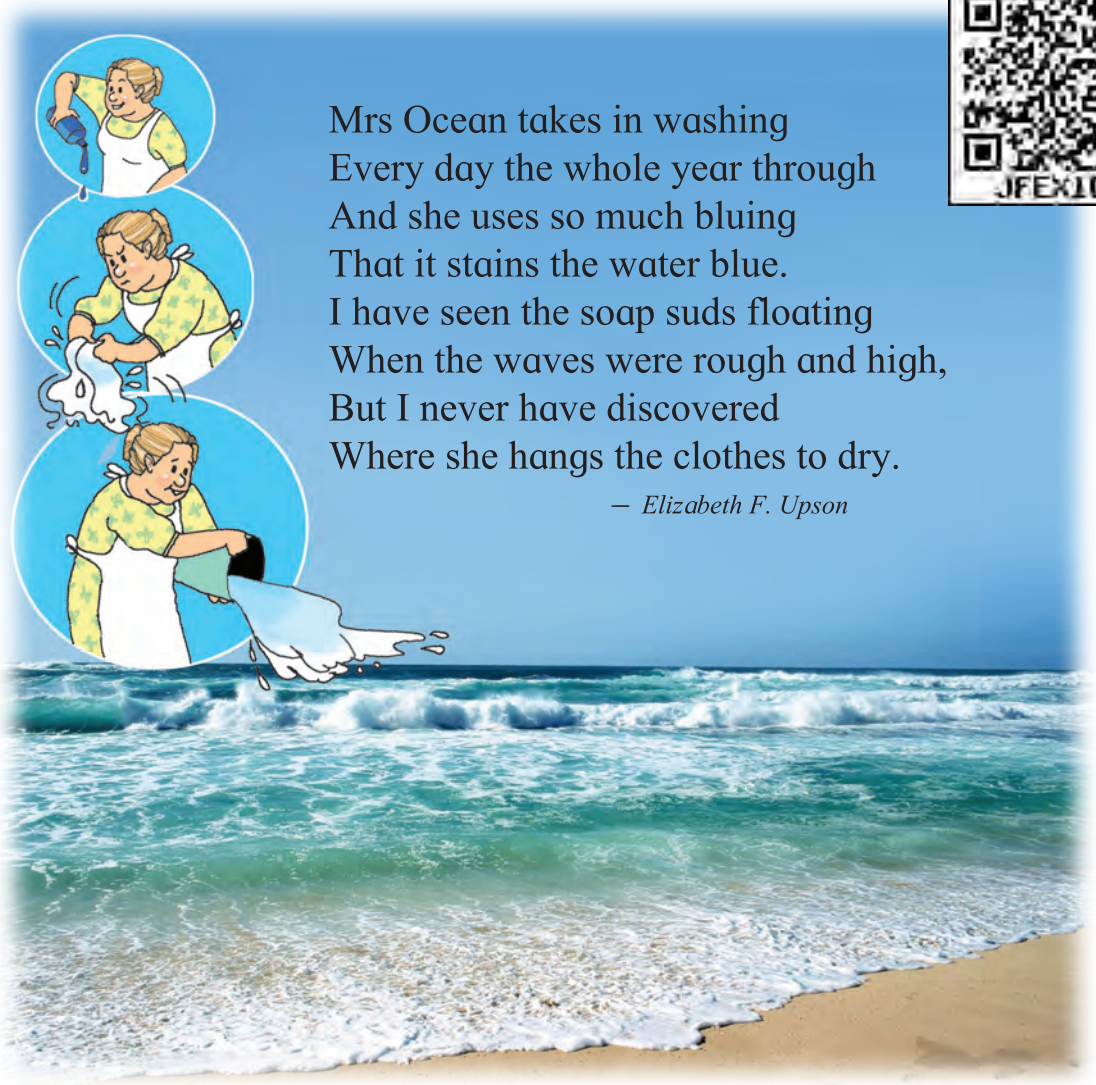
33. Washday



Mrs Ocean takes in washing
Every day the whole year through
And she uses so much bluing
That it stains the water blue.
I have seen the soap suds floating
When the waves were rough and high,
But I never have discovered
Where she hangs the clothes to dry.

— *Elizabeth F. Upson*

- **bluing :** blue substance that is used in washing to make yellowing fabrics look whiter.
- **stains :** colours.
- **soap suds :** foam or lather formed in soapy water.

Things to do :

1. Answer the following questions :
   (a) What is the ocean called in this poem ?
   (b) What does Mrs Ocean do every day ?
   (c) Why does the sea water turn blue ?
   (d) What do the waves breaking on the shore look like ?

2. The poet uses her imagination to talk about Mrs Ocean.
   Can you use your imagination to talk about the following ?
   (a) Mr Moon (b) Mr Sun (c) Ms Earth